

1 Participle Clauses

Participle clauses use an -ing verb to add extra information, combining two simple sentences into one complex sentence, helping you demonstrate a wider range of grammar.

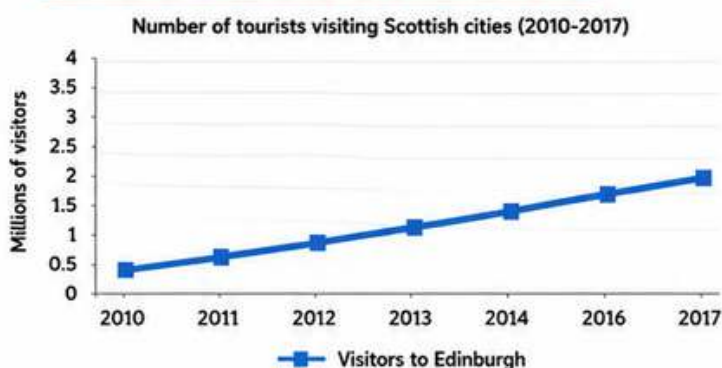


Great for graphics that show a trend over time...



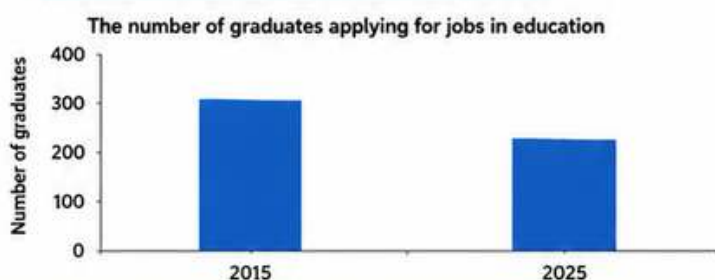
... but they can be used with any graphic type 💪

EXAMPLE 1 – LINE GRAPH (TREND OVER TIME)



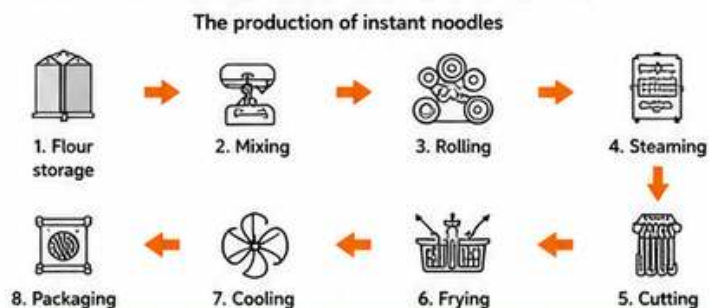
The number of visitors to Edinburgh increased throughout the period, **reaching** 2 million in 2017.

EXAMPLE 2 – BAR CHART (COMPARISON)



The number of graduates applying for jobs in education decreased, **declining** from 300 to just above 200 in 2015 and 2025, respectively.

EXAMPLE 3 – PROCESS DIAGRAM (PROCESS)



The diagram illustrates the stages involved in the production of instant noodles, **tracing** the process from flour storage to the final packaging stage.

KEY RULES

- ✓ Use an -ing verb to begin the participle clause.
- ✓ A participle clause adds extra information to the main clause.
- ✓ It can describe a trend, a result, an end point or a process.
- ✓ It can be used with any graphic type (line graphs, bar charts, tables, pie charts, maps, diagrams, etc.).

GRAMMAR TIP



Two simple sentences
= **lower Grammar score**



One complex sentence
= **higher Grammar score**

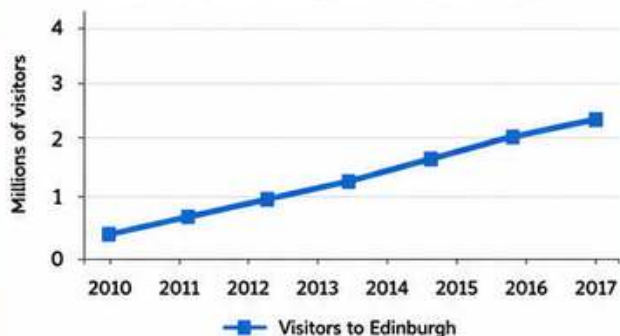
2 Relative Clauses

Relative clauses give extra information about a noun.

In most Task 1 graphics, we use 'which' to describe categories.

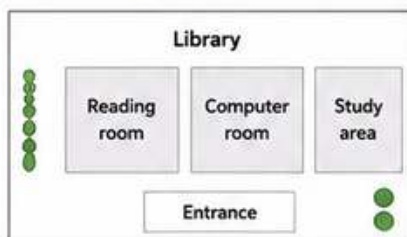
EXAMPLE 1 – LINE GRAPH

Number of tourists visiting Scottish cities (2010-2017)



Visitors to Edinburgh, **which began at 0.5 million in 2010**, increased steadily throughout the period, **reaching 2.5 million in 2017**.

EXAMPLE 2 – MAP



The reading room, **which is next to the computer room**, is used to house newspapers and magazines.

WHICH / WHO / WHERE / WHOSE



For **things** use **which**.

Visitor numbers, **which** increased in both cities, rose more sharply in Glasgow than in Edinburgh.



For **people** use **who**.

Tourists visiting Glasgow, **who** numbered around 0.5 million in 2010, increased to roughly 3.5 million by 2017.



For **places** use **where**.

Glasgow, **where** the number of tourists increased from 0.5 to 3 million, was the most popular city by the end of the period.



For **places** use **which** if followed by a verb.

Glasgow, **which** attracted around 0.5 million tourists in 2010, saw visitor numbers rise to approximately 3 million by 2017.



For **possession** use **whose**.

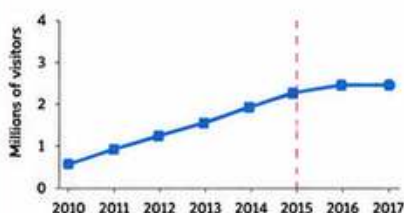
Glasgow, **whose** tourism industry expanded considerably between 2010 and 2017, became the most popular city.

ADVANCED RELATIVE CLAUSES – ADDING MORE DETAIL ABOUT TIME

AFTER WHICH



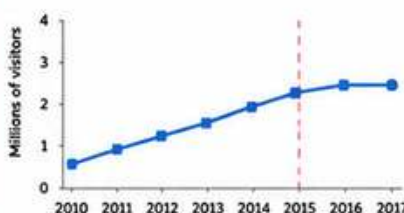
Visitor numbers increased steadily from 2010 to 2015, **after which** they levelled off.



AT WHICH POINT



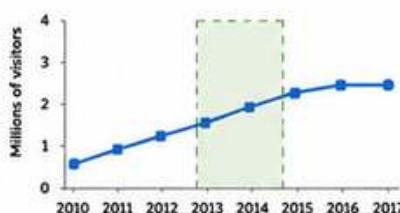
Visitor numbers continued to rise until 2015, **at which point** they stabilised.



DURING WHICH



Visitor numbers increased significantly **during which** the city hosted several major events.



TOP TIPS

1. Use relative clauses to add extra information and make your writing more detailed.
2. Put the relative clause as close as possible to the noun (the thing or person) it describes.
3. Use **commas** before and after non-defining relative clauses (extra information).
4. In most Task 1 graphics, you will be using 'which' to describe categories and data.

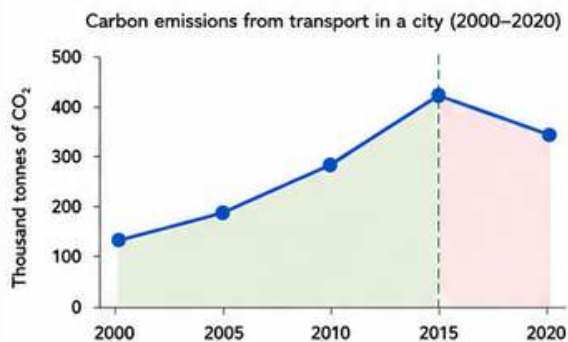
3 Before / After + -ing

We use *before / after + -ing* to refer to events or changes that happened before or after a point in time.

GRAMMAR RULES

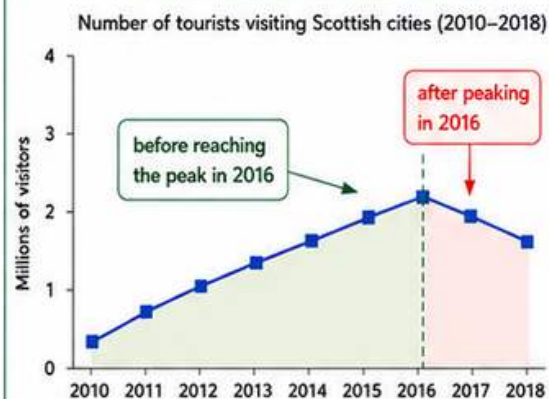
- ✓ Use **before + -ing** to refer to what happened first.
- ✓ Use **after + -ing** to refer to what happened next.
- ✓ The **-ing** form refers to a complete action.
- ✓ Use a **comma** after *before / after + -ing* if it comes at the start of a clause.

EXAMPLE – LINE GRAPH (SPECIFIC POINT)



Carbon emissions increased steadily **before reaching** a peak in 2015. **After peaking**, they declined slightly by 2020.

USE WITH TRENDS OVER TIME



Visitor numbers increased steadily **before reaching** their peak in 2016. **After peaking**, they declined slightly until 2018.

AVOID WITH ONE MOMENT IN TIME



Don't use *before / after + -ing* for graphics that show a single moment in time (e.g. bar charts, pie charts, maps, diagrams).

USE WITH TRENDS OR CHANGE OVER TIME

Use *before / after + -ing* with:



Line graphs



Area charts



Timelines

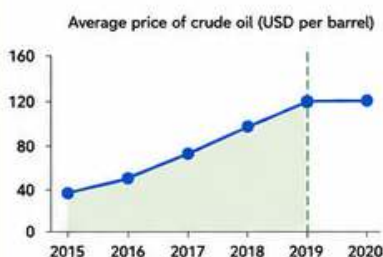


Processes

MORE EXAMPLES

BEFORE + -ING

Prices rose steadily **before reaching** a peak of \$120 in 2019.

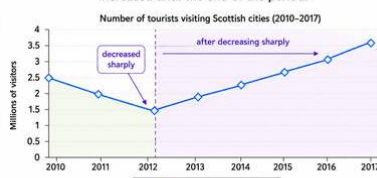


MEANING

The increase happened first. It reached \$120 at that point.

AFTER + -ING

After decreasing sharply, the number of visitors increased until the end of the period.



The number of visitors decreased sharply. After decreasing sharply, it increased until the end of the period.

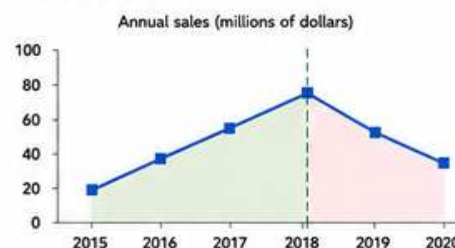


MEANING
The decrease happened first. The increase happened after that and continued until the end.



BEFORE + -ING AND AFTER + -ING

Sales increased steadily **before reaching** a peak in 2018. **After peaking**, they fell sharply in 2019.



MEANING

The increase happened first. The decrease happened after the peak.



TWO SIMPLE SENTENCES

Prices rose steadily.
They reached a peak in 2019.

✗ = lower Grammar score



ONE COMPLEX SENTENCE

Prices rose steadily **before reaching** a peak in 2019.

✓ = higher Grammar score

